

UNIT 3: SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT AROUND THE WORLD

Class Time: Minimum 75 Minutes

Description

Now that the basic concepts of sustainable development have been reviewed (Unit 1 & 2), your students are ready to use sustainable development as an analytical tool. To start with, the lesson begins with a brief presentation from your students on the history of sustainable development based on their homework assignment from Unit 1 (See Activity 9: The Sustainable Development Timeline). Students can place their work on the wall in sequential order so that the progress made in sustainable development is clearly identified.

Following the presentations, students are divided into groups for the activity “Sustainable Development Around the World” (See Activity 10: Sustainable Development around the World). Students are asked to use human development data sets to analyze and compare sustainable development in three countries. Following this, students will be asked to develop initiatives for one of the three countries that would help the country improve their sustainable development practices.

Curriculum Expectations

The Sustainable Development Timeline

Overall Expectations:

SSV.03 – demonstrate an understanding of the cultural, economic, and political aspirations of selected groups and the effects of their actions on local, national, and global issues.

HEV.03 – evaluate approaches, policies, and principles relating to the protection and sustainability of the planet’s life-support systems.

GCV.03 – identify the contributions made by a variety of individuals, organizations, and institutions to sustainable development strategies for the developing world, and evaluate their economic, environmental and social impact.

UCV.03 – evaluate the effectiveness of methods used by different organizations, governments, and industries to find short- and long-term solutions to geographic problems and issues at the local, national and global level.

Specific Expectations:

SS1.05 – identify ways in which countries and regions are becoming increasingly interdependent.

HE1.03 – explain how people perceive resources and sustainable development differently at different times and in different places.

HE2.05 – evaluate some of the ways of promoting sustainable development and assess the effectiveness in selected places and regions of the world.

HE3.03 – assess the contribution of selected government policies to sustainable resource development in Canada.

GC1.05 – identify individuals who have made a significant contribution to addressing global issues and evaluate their impacts.

UC3.06 – evaluate the effectiveness of an international strategy and agreement that has been designed to protect the global commons or address global issues.

Sustainable Development around the World

Overall Expectations:

HEV.02 – analyse geographic issues that arise from the impact of human activities on the environment in different regions of the world.

HEV.03 - evaluate approaches, policies, and principles relating to the protection and sustainability of the planet's life-support systems.

UCV.01 – analyse, forecast, and evaluate changes in the human use of the earth and its resources.

Specific Expectations:

HE1.03 - explain how people perceive resources and sustainable development differently at different times and in different places.

HE2.05 - evaluate some of the ways of promoting sustainable development and assess the effectiveness in selected places and regions of the world.

HE3.03 – assess the contribution of selected government policies to sustainable resource development in Canada.

UC3.04 – produce an action plan for a local community initiative that contributes to the sustainability of a selected global resource.

UC3.05 – evaluate the effectiveness of an international strategy and agreement that has been designed to protect the global commons or address global issues.

Prior Knowledge and Skills

- Knowledge of global environmental trends (climate change, biodiversity, pollution, desertification, deforestation) and a familiarisation with the international agreements that address these trends (Kyoto protocol, the Convention on Biodiversity, etc).
- An understanding of human development trends and how they influence geographic issues (birth/death rates, GDP, child mortality, emissions, etc).
- Statistical Analysis, GIS basic knowledge.

Planning Notes

- Photocopy 1 copy of Worksheet 11 for each group
- Photocopy Supplementary Sheets 1 to 3 for the activity “Sustainable Development around the World”.
- Have your students bring in Appendix 1 to 3 used in Units 1 and 2
- Photocopy Sustainable Development Projects in Cameroon and Nicaragua (See Appendix 6).

Teaching/Learning Strategies

Most of the learning strategies are described in each activity, but here are some of the overall strategies for the unit.

- Before starting Unit 3, the teacher should quickly review the concepts of sustainable development.
- Students will use sustainable development as an analytical tool.
- Provide enough time and the material needed to facilitate the poster presentation.
- Ask students to place their work on the wall in sequential order so that the class can clearly see the progress made in sustainable development.

- Divide the class into groups of 4 or 5 students for Activity 10: Sustainable Development around the World.
- Ask students to use human development data sets to analyse and compare sustainable development in three countries (Supplementary Sheets 1 to 3).
- In step one, the students will analyse the current status of each country in terms of the dimensions of sustainable development: economic, environmental and social.
- In step two, each group will be assigned one of the selected countries. They will take on the role of a development organization interested in selecting some sustainable development goals that are appropriate for their selected country.
- In step three, students will be asked to develop initiatives for in order to improve the sustainable development practices of that particular country.
- Introduce students to the new vocabulary and concepts listed in each activity. Refer them to the glossary.
- Refer students to the accompanying material, the supplementary sheets, and where to go to find information.
- Encourage students to analyse more in-depth the information provided and to research the websites given for this unit.
- Monitor the group work and the simulation game so students can gain maximum benefits from the activity.

Accommodations

Frequent monitoring and assistance should be provided. Accommodations that are normally provided in the regular classroom for students with special needs should be provided. Here are some strategies for helping them.

- Information should be presented to as many modalities as possible through oral presentations, board notes, diagrams, class discussions, activity-based learning.
- Instructions should be clear, concise, to the point, verbally rehearsed by the student, properly sequenced, reviewed after a time lapse, written down on the board or in a notebook.
- Assignments should be outlined in writing, written in the students' homework/assignment book, written (and left) on the blackboard, broken down by step with the teacher, rehearsed / modelled, and scheduled step by step.
- Questioning should be clear, concise, allowing for appropriate response time. Students need time to organise their thoughts, match them with the appropriate vocabulary, put them in correct syntax, sequence the ideas and finally express them with good speech. All these skills, most others take for granted.
- Encourage students to question for clarification and additional information. Learn to speak at a slower rate of speech. Avoid figurative language unless it has been specifically pre-taught. Encourage and evaluate oral responses and class participation. Allow extra time (e.g. homework) for students to complete assignments that others students may finish in class time. Create extra practice opportunities with new vocabulary or concepts. Provide overviews or lesson highlights at the beginning of class. Discuss and simplify sophisticated vocabulary or language. Finally, give several short assignments rather than one long one.